

Content for the April/May 2025 Newsletter

1. EV Mini Expo 22 June - TILE

2. Federal Labor's Battery Incentives

Labor's \$2.3b battery program applies to people with existing solar or for those wanting to invest in a new solar-plus-battery set up.

It's not mean tested and offers a 30% discount on batteries for households, businesses and community facilities such as sports centres and town halls.

Households with existing solar could save up to \$1,100 extra off their power bills every year and up to \$2,300 a year for those with new solar.

It applies to batteries up to 50 kWh.

The rebate will be available from 1 July 2025. The aim is to have 1m batteries installed by 2030. This will ensure up to 1m households get a financial benefit from the transition to an electricity system run on renewable energy.

The NSW Government also has a battery incentive of up to \$2,400.(add website link)

3. Donating to the Public Fund - TILE

Thank you so much for your contributions to SHASA's Public Fund!

I thought you might like to know that SHASA spends 100% of your tax deductible donations on projects that support our mission of **Climate Leadership and Adaptation for the Eurobodalla and beyond**. We continue to seek funding for practical projects that cut energy costs and support local communities to transition to clean energy.

For the 2024/25 Financial Year SHASA used your generous donations to:

- Employ a Project Coordinator to Develop a Community Facility Resilience Strategy so that we can secure grant funds for solar, batteries, EV chargers, LED lighting etc to cut energy costs and make community spaces more comfortable year round.

- Purchase two 3m high gazebos to use at EV Expos for much needed shading over cars and volunteers
- Install air quality monitoring stations at 3 sites in the Eurobodalla.
- Support the Repurposing for Resilience "Computers 4 Community" project which gives new life to old computers, monitors and laptops. These are then gifted to people in need and not for profits.

Its a great time to donate to the SHASA Public Fund

It's Tax Time, and you will receive a tax deduction for donating to the SHASA Public Fund.

You can donate online on the SHASA website www.shasa.com.au/membership-and-donations/

or make a direct deposit into the SHASA Public Trust Account:

BSB: 641 800

Account: 200924351

Lyn's tile

4. EuroBEV 1 June - TILE

1 June at Grump's and Sweethearts in Mogo

5. Moruya Surf Club Haven

Spotlight on heat havens: Moruya Surf Lifesaving Club

A heatwave and bushfire smoke haven is a refuge from heat and bushfire smoke that is available to members of the community. The Eurobodalla havens are usually volunteer run, and welcome people whose homes are not adapted for extreme heat or who need respite from heat or bushfire smoke.

As havens are completed, SHASA will provide a detailed profile of each. As our summers get hotter and we experience above average temperatures year round, it is important that people are aware of places in the community where they can take refuge in the event of fire, flood, bushfire smoke or heatwave scenarios.

SHASA successfully applied for funding to install a solar battery, backup generator, ducted air conditioning and LED lights to ensure that the club can continue operations in the event

of a power blackout. The club has also replaced all gas in its commercial kitchen so that it is now fully electric.

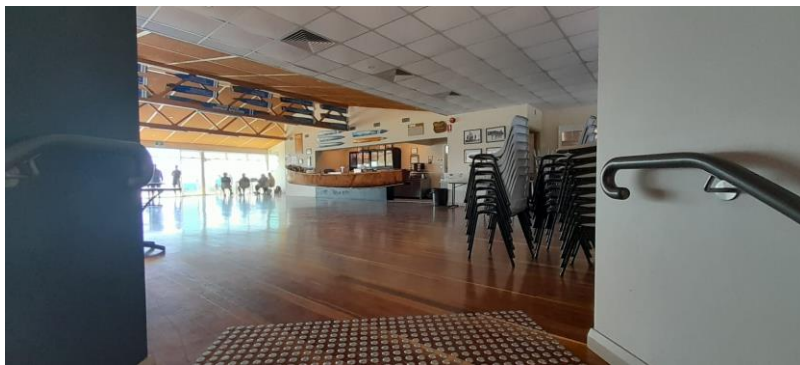
The upstairs area of the club is usually used for events and functions, so has chairs and tables for 120 people. It also has a commercial kitchen and bar, and separate male and female toilets. With ducted air conditioning, this space can also accommodate people overnight (as it does for competitors in the George Bass Marathon) but there are no camp beds or sleeping equipment provided.

A lift which is wheelchair accessible can bring people from the ground floor to the first floor, for those who have difficulty with stairs. Likewise, there is a beach wheelchair to transport anyone from the beach to the club.

The ground floor where the accessible toilet and shower is located. There are also separate male and female showers (3 cubicles in each) and toilets, a fully equipped first aid room, and a gym room with kitchenette.

Outside, there is an undercover BBQ area with sink and fridge, and an outdoor toilet block (with an accessible toilet, baby change facility, and outdoor showers).

Located at 2 Charles Moffitt Dr, Moruya Heads, the heat haven is open to members of the surf club and the public. Check to see if it is open by calling (02) 4474 2674, emailing info@moruyasurf.org.au, or on their Facebook page: <https://www.facebook.com/moruya.slsc>



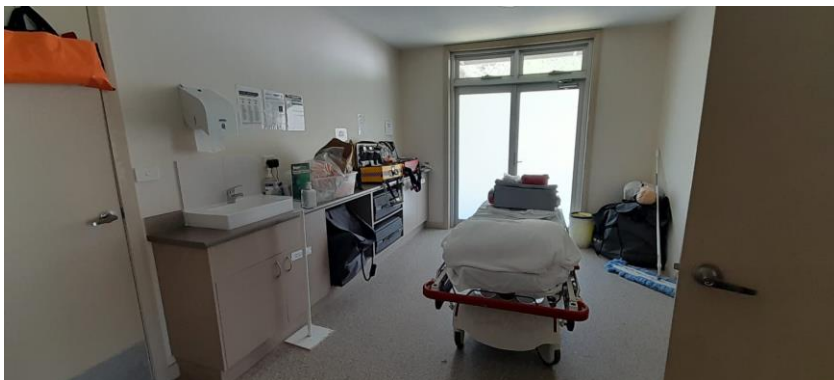
Upstairs space with seating and bar



Commercial kitchen upstairs



Wheelchair accessible lift



Downstairs first aid room



Downstairs gym room with kitchenette



6. Sustainable House Day - 2 Jeffery Place

On Sunday 4 May SHASA President Kathryn Maxwell and her partner Thomas Schild participated in the RENEW Sustainable House Day. Thomas ran 4 tours with 25 attendees. They learnt about how to build a home that is comfortable, cheap to run and with a lower building cost.

Key features of the house include:

- steel floor frame and particle board floor with expanded polystyrene underfloor insulation
- structural Insulated panels for walls and ceiling
- double glazing on all windows and glass doors
- the building is 95% recyclable and has much lower embodied energy than conventional homes
- north facing with large floor to ceiling glass doors opening onto a large sunny deck
- awning on eastern window to keep out the summer heat and let in the morning winter sun
- curtains and blinds on all windows to keep out the winter cold
- 9kW of rooftop solar and 12kWh house battery
- 7kW EV home charger
- energy efficient appliances
- active heating and cooling with energy efficient reverse cycle air conditioners
- 15,000 litres of rainwater tanks plumbed into the toilet and laundry
- native garden
- home composting and growing of veggies and herbs

A big thank you to

- Kirsten Pilot from Eurobodalla Shire Council who had a table with water efficiency information and giveaways.
- SHASA members Andrew Everard, Andrea Charlton, Valerie Faber, David Morris and Michael Brown who ran the welcome desk, the SHASA raffle and gave people an opportunity to learn more about the 4 EVs that were parked on the verge.

Congratulations to Rob of Tuross Head who won a SHASA home energy assessment to the value of \$250.

PHOTOS

7. Joining SHASA

Lyn's tile

Moruya to Adelaide & back in our EV

By Natalie Barnett

March 2025 we had a trip from Moruya to Adelaide to visit family & to see the *Chihuly Glass Art Exhibition* at the Adelaide Botanic Garden. The exhibition was AMAZING! So glad we went.

We usually drive our ICE car to Adelaide, taking two days & overnighing in Hay. With our ICE car at the mechanics for an unspecified time, we had no option than to take our BYD Atto3 EV with a 60kW battery. Our concerns were mostly about getting across the Hay Plain with limited chargers (only one charger available in Narrandera, Hay & Balranald & the extra time required for charging). So we decided to take three days & overnight in Wagga (with family) & Mildura (in a pet friendly AirBnB as we had our two fur-babies with us) & do the reverse coming home. A benefit of the Atto3 is being able to charge to 100% on a DC (fast) charger with no damage to the battery.

I took photos of the driver's display when we left home, when we arrived at a charging station, when we left a charging station & when we arrived in Adelaide & same again coming home. This gave the data for odometer, battery %, time & temperature.

The trip to Adelaide went as smoothly as it possibly could... all chargers working, no wait times & no issues. Charging was done at loo-stops & meal times. We left home with 100% battery (from house solar), we charged at Braidwood (69% to 94%) & Gundagai (30% to 96%) then on to Wagga.

The second day we charged at Wagga whilst eating breakfast then walking the fur-girls (65% to 98%), on to Narrandera (69% to 94%), Hay (38% to 72%), Balranald (29% to 86%) & finally Mildura. The third day we charged at Mildura whilst eating breakfast then walking the fur-girls (31% To 97%), then at Barmera (44% to 78%), Waikerie (62% to 98%) & on to Adelaide (arrive 40% & we travelled 1385km).

It was hot whilst traveling beyond Braidwood & the car A/C didn't work quite as well as in cooler temps as the car was obviously needing to spend more energy cooling the battery.

The difference when we went from Vic/NSW to SA was INCREDIBLE! So many towns had 2+ chargers, (often four!) & 120kW/200kW – so good fast chargers. All RAA (Chargefox) – we were very impressed... so much better than here in NSW! The four bay chargers often had an accessible bay... it says '*Priority bay, use last*', for wheelchairs, elderly, injured & prams & they had extra space around the bay to accommodate this (see pic).

Whilst in Adelaide ... we charged to 95% & did some driving around town. But on the return journey, we were not quite so lucky.

We left Adelaide with 73% battery & charged at Truro (42% to 87%), Renmark (38% to 91%), then on to Mildura to stay overnight & we charged there from 46% to 100%. Next day, we charged at Balranald (43% to 93%), then on to Hay... but the NRMA charger in Hay was down.

A look on the PlugShare app said someone reported it 2 days prior. I rang the NRMA EV Hotline & unfortunately the unit was not able to be 'reset' remotely (NRMA had managed to do this for me once before in Sydney but it really depends on the issue). There are Tesla chargers in Hay but our 2022 Atto3 is not compatible with them. When we purchased the car, only Teslas could use Tesla chargers so it wasn't an issue but since then, Tesla has since opened up their network to other vehicles... realising that they can make money from it! Hopefully a 'fix' is coming from BYD soon.

Luckily... Hay local council had recently installed four 7kW AC (slow) chargers in the same carpark as the NRMA charger (these are similar to what people can have installed at home) & we could borrow a cable from the Tourist Information Centre across the road. We arrived at Hay about 1.30pm, with faffing around with the NRMA charger, phone calls & getting the AC cable etc... we didn't start charging until about 2pm. We charged for 2 hours (44% to 68%), then set off to Narrandera, although we knocked down our top speed to reduce kWh usage on this leg. We were able to charge at Narrandera (12% to 54%) then drove to Wagga arriving with 14% charge & arrived just before 8pm. The 12% & 14% arrival rates are about as fine as I like to cut it... really didn't want to call & wait for Roadside Assist to tow us the final few kms!

If those council slow chargers weren't available, we would have needed to stay overnight in Hay. We would have contacted the usual Motel we stay at (when in our ICE car), hoping they had a room available for us & the fur-girls. This would be extra cost, plus extra dinner/breakfast costs & also hope the Motel would allow us to somehow '*plug in*' & trickle charge overnight (we had our AC trickle charger & a 10m extension lead with us). We would have given some money for that, of course.

On the third day we charged in Wagga, whilst eating breakfast then walking the fur-girls (14% to 99%), Gundagai (70% to 96%), Braidwood (28% to 55%) & then home (arrived with 35%) & a total of 2839km.

There was a stretch between Truro & Mildura where it was hot, really windy & we could smell smoke (with smoke plume visible in the distance). We seemed to chew through the battery at this time.

Total charging costs \$311.04. Comparison approx. total petrol cost \$426 (approx. 213L average premium fuel @ \$2/L that our ICE car uses).

Take home message? We need more & better charging options in rural NSW!

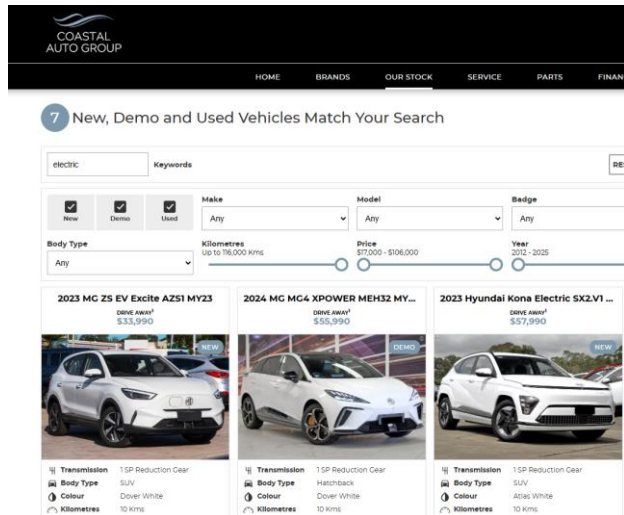
8. Computer support - Trish Pye

9. EV Fleets - novated leasing - Andrew Everard

10. NSW Forest Logging Update - Jo Maclean

Are there any local dealerships and service places at the coast? (Emphasise longer service intervals).

Coastal Auto Group sells and services EVs as well as some hybrid vehicles.



If I buy an EV from you, where can I get it serviced?

Mar 28, 2025, 5:03 PM

Olivia

If you purchase an electric vehicle (EV) from us at AMH - Coastal Auto Group, you can get it serviced at any of our dealerships that are equipped to handle EVs. We provide sales, service, and parts for MG, Subaru, Hyundai, and Toyota vehicles, including electric models. Our service departments are staffed with highly trained technicians who are well-versed in the latest EV technology and use genuine parts to ensure the highest quality of workmanship.

To book your service, you can do so online, give us a call, or visit us in person at the dealership. We'll find a time that suits you and ensure that your EV receives the best possible care. Our commitment to quality service and customer satisfaction means that you can trust us to maintain your vehicle to the highest standards.

Get in Touch for Service Inquiry

Mar 28, 2025, 5:03 PM

What happens if something goes wrong with my car, do I need to go back to Canberra to get it fixed while it is still under warranty?

If you can buy the car in the Eurobodalla from a local dealership, they should be able to fix it for you. Our older model Leaf goes to Bega for servicing - which it only needs about once in 2 years. Service intervals in EVs are considerably longer than for combustion engines and there are far fewer moving parts to manage.

There are (a) not enough charging stations at the coast and there is (b) the perception that people can't make it from the Coast to Canberra on one charge.

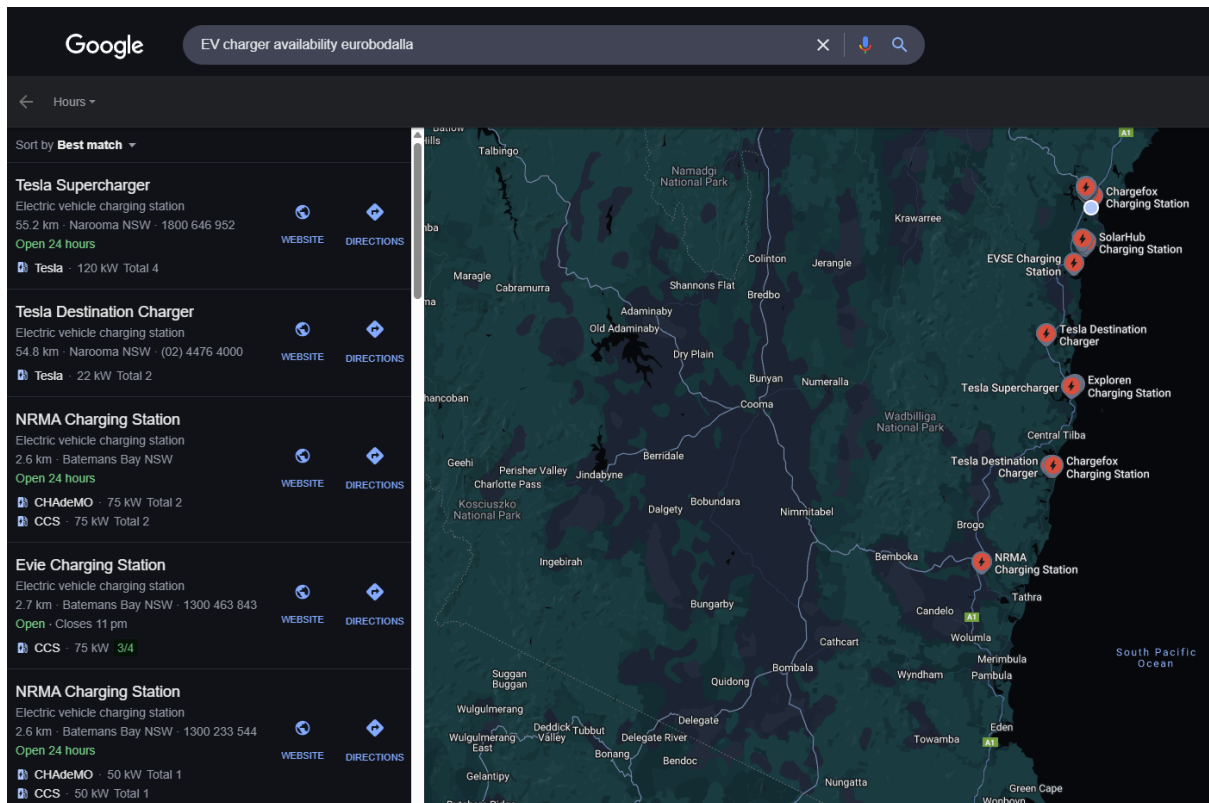
Back in 2023 SHASA identified an issue with insufficient chargers available on the south coast. Since then a lot of progress has been made. From three chargers in Batemans Bay there are now ten fast chargers, three destination chargers and three more Tesla chargers under construction. While it will still be very busy at peak periods, Plug Share (app for smartphone) shows you where all the chargers are, and users can report errors or out of service issues. Drivers have more options than ever before.

Most people will always charge at home using solar power or off peak to reduce costs. The number of fast chargers is important on longer road trips, or for drivers who can't charge at home.

A new EV has a much larger range than an older car. Batteries are more efficient, have on board cooling systems so they can charge faster without getting too hot, and fit more battery in the same space. Andrew and Andrea's 2018 Leaf with 40KW and notional range of 230 km can make it to Canberra from the Bay without stopping but without a lot of spare power left when we get there. Now that there's a good charger in Braidwood (Soldiers' Club), we always stop there for 20 minutes and a coffee and no more problems.

The average battery size for a 2024 car is 50-70kWh with some models up to 100kWh. That translates to about 283 km per charge up to 500 km for the top of the line. Canberra to Melbourne is 683 km so you should expect to charge at least once en route even in the biggest EV. It's a good reminder to take a break and enjoy the journey.

If you want to work it out yourself, try here <https://evpowerhouse.com.au/electric-vehicle-range-time-calculator/>



Should the batteries be "trickle" charged to extend the battery life? Is it ok to charge up just a little bit or will that have an impact on the battery life? (I can remember where I was reading the story about battery life being much longer than originally anticipated).

Older batteries need thoughtful management and to keep them running well it's best not to charge to 100 percent or deplete to under 10 percent too often (applies to ChaDeMo and other older EVs). Newer car batteries have improved cooling systems and charging management and they last longer with less reduction in performance. Slower, rather than faster, charging is recommended for the best overall performance and that's what most people do at home.

People are still concerned about the potential fire risk of an EV so it might be good to have the stats again about the numbers (in comparison to their market share).

Do EVs cause fires?



Fire likelihood

Fact: EVs are far less likely to catch fire than petrol vehicles

Worldwide studies show EVs have a far lower risk of catching fire than internal combustion vehicles.

The International Energy Agency reports there are now 40 million EVs on the road worldwide.

From 2010 to June 2024, EV FireSafe recorded 511 verified passenger EV battery fires across the world. It says 6 EVs caught fire in Australia between 2010 and September 2023.

In comparison, there were 2,803 internal combustion vehicle fires in NSW alone in the 2022–23 financial year according to Fire and Rescue NSW incident data.

In Sweden, there were 23 reported fires in 2022 out of 611,000 electric vehicles (0.004%). Over the same period, 3,400 fires were reported from the nation's 4.4 million petrol and diesel cars (0.077%). Either type of fire could have been caused by a range of incidents, including building fires, arson and crashes.

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One discussion I had (with a geologist) was around the rare earth issue and that some minerals are in short supply so EV are not really suitable for the future.

The demand for some rare earths and other resources needed to make EVs, batteries, solar panels and wind turbines is predicted to increase by 400% to 600% over the next decade as renewables

come to dominate the power market and EVs replace internal combustion engines for most applications. While there are, on paper, sufficient resources to meet the demand, extracting them also presents technical, social and economic challenges -

<https://news.climate.columbia.edu/2023/04/05/the-energy-transition-will-need-more-rare-earth-elements-can-we-secure-them-sustainably/>

1. Effectively recycling rare and expensive elements will be necessary, and is already possible.
2. Substituting common elements (like sodium for example) for rare ones (like lithium) is also a strategy that is being tested in laboratories.
3. Vehicle batteries will last much longer than expected - now that we have data on how fast their performance degrades over time, the news is good. They should be performing well into their second decade. When they aren't useful in cars any longer, EV batteries can power houses, businesses, buildings for another life cycle. And when they're too old, reclamation and recycling are the preferred options.







Australia has reached the 'electrification tipping point'

March 28, 2025

The new modelling shows that households who switch to an electric car, solar and electric appliances could save more than \$4,000 a year, even when including upfront costs.

Our new report '[The Electrification Tipping Point](#)' shows the economics in Australia have passed a crucial milestone: buying an electric appliance or vehicle is cheaper than the fossil-fuel powered alternative, even when you consider the upfront costs.

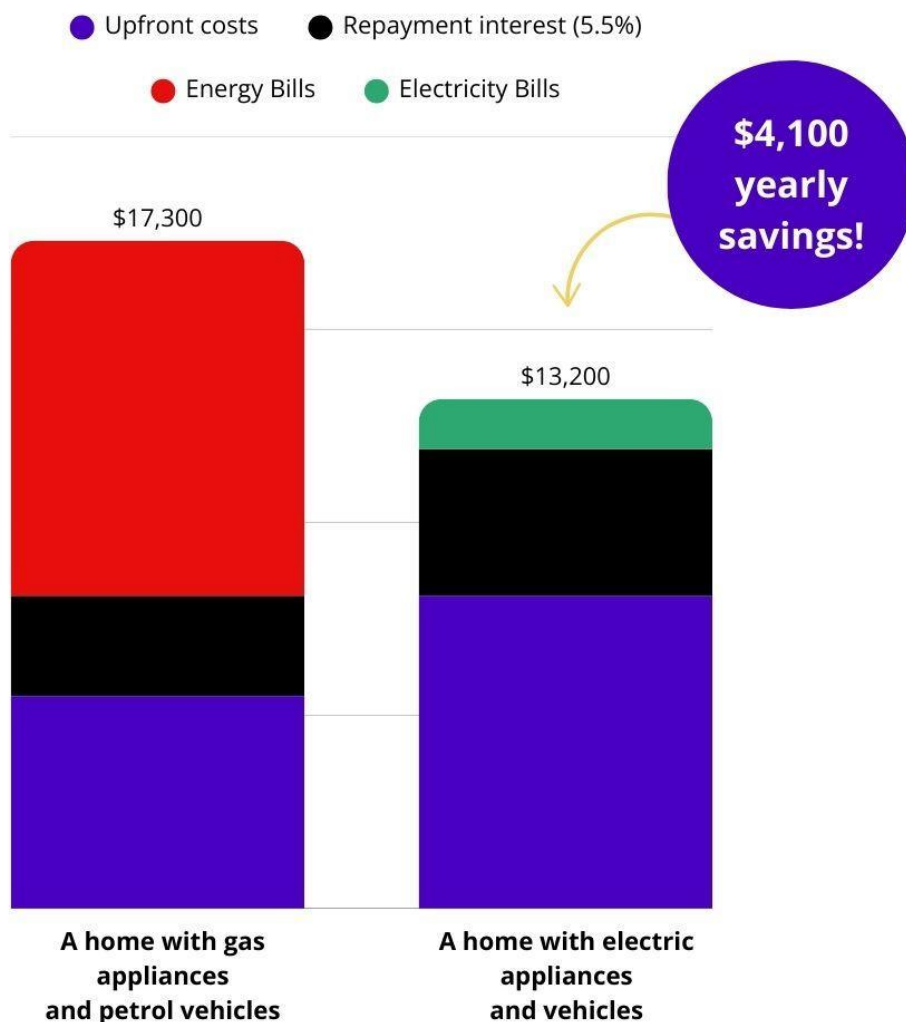
That means buying an efficient, electric appliance is always going to be cheaper than its fossil fuel alternative. It's a climate solution that's good for the hip pocket.

The report comes as political parties race to provide cost-of-living relief through energy rebates and fuel excises ahead of the election, but this latest research shows there is a longer-term solution which will provide more value for money, and that's by fully electrifying households, including vehicles.

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HOUSEHOLD ENERGY COSTS: AUSTRALIA

Gas and petrol home versus solar electric host cost comparison over 15 years, average Australian home energy needs (includes energy bills and upfront costs)



Sources: Rewiring Australia analysis. Residential Baseline Study 2021 average home energy needs. ABS motor vehicle survey 2018 average driving per vehicle. 1.8 vehicles per home. 2025 energy prices adjusted for future years based on historic real inflation of each energy type from the Consumer Price Index. \$2025. Capital costs financed at 5.5% interest. 9kW solar install and 10kWh battery on electrified home.



***The Electrification Tipping Point* report has found households using gas appliances and petrol vehicles could save \$61,500 over 15 years, or more than \$4,000 a year on average, if they upgrade their appliances and vehicles to**

efficient, electric ones and get their power from a combination of rooftop solar, a home battery, and the existing electricity grid.

This calculation includes the cost of buying and installing the cars and appliances, financed with repayment interest at 5.5 per cent over a 15-year appliance lifetime.

The report shows taking even small steps towards electrifying Australian homes, such as switching from a gas heater to reverse cycle air conditioning could save households hundreds of dollars in just 12 months.

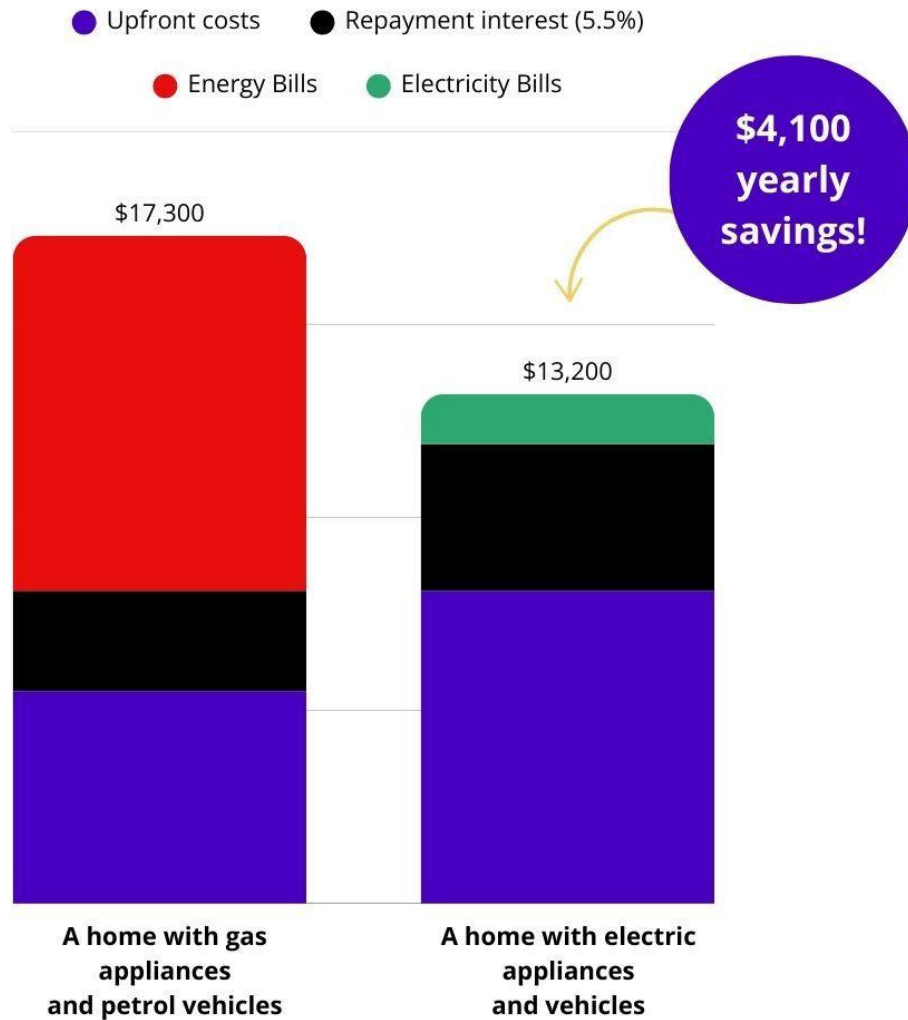
- Driving an electric vehicle saves around \$1500 per year in driving costs, or \$2500 per year if that car is charged with solar.
- Upgrading from a gas hot water system to a heat pump hot water heater will save \$250 per year on energy bills.
- Installing rooftop solar to power those electric appliances and vehicles can save an additional \$2200 per year.
- The average fossil fuel-powered home that goes fully electric with solar and a battery can save \$4,100 per year.

According to our Co-Founder and Chief Scientist Dr Saul Griffith, “This tipping point shows Australians can save money on energy bills and cut emissions as soon as they electrify. This is a far better deal than what an energy bill rebate or fuel excise can offer.”

Read the full report [here](#).

COMPARE THE FULL COSTS

Gas and petrol home versus solar electric host cost comparison over 15 years, average Australian home energy needs (includes energy bills and upfront costs)

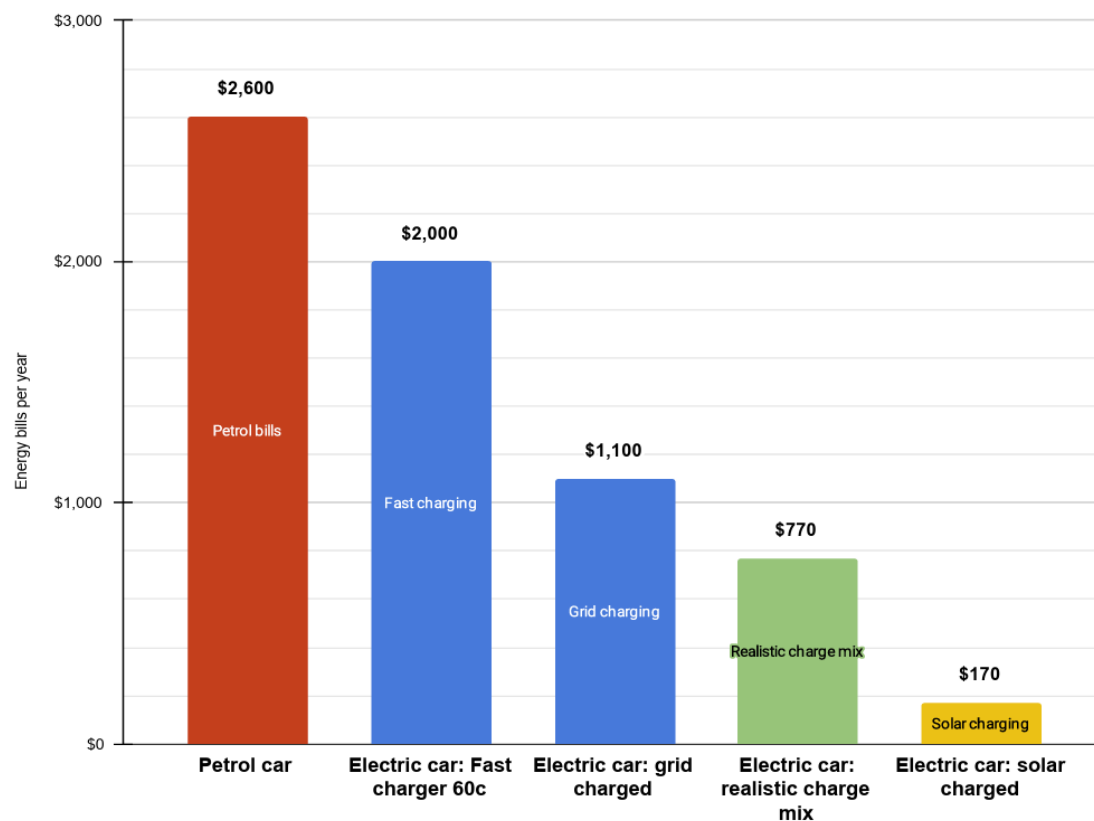


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Driving fuel/charging comparison per year (\$2025 prices)

Average Australian driving and energy pricing



Source notes: Rewiring Australia analysis. ABS motor vehicle survey 2018 average driving distance. Vehicle efficiency from US EPA fuel economy database comparing common Australian vehicles. 2025 electricity, petrol, and solar prices. Charge mix 50% solar, 35% grid, 15% public charging.

Are EVs good for business? Certainly!

While most EVs so far have been purchased by individual owners, there are many businesses that can, and should, benefit from EVs lower running costs, minimal maintenance costs, advanced driver and car safety options, and ease of operation.

Some larger businesses, like AGL, have undertaken to electrify their business fleet by 2025 - under their policy, your work car should be electric unless there's a good reason - the lack of EV uses for example.

But for smaller businesses and organisations in NSW, the current fleet incentives (<https://www.energy.nsw.gov.au/business-and-industry/programs-grants-and-schemes/electric-vehicles/electric-vehicle-fleets/faqs>) apply only to fleets of ten cars or more. This disadvantages smaller organisations, and workers who are individual contractors. There are many such

organisations in the Eurobodalla, and contractors and employees of small businesses often rack up a lot of mileage to deliver services equitably to our spread out population.

Novated leasing is an option that could deliver the benefits of EV driving to those organisations that have been disadvantaged until now. If an employer is able to accept salary packaging, a car lease can be included as part of the employee or contractor's remuneration. The employee won't have to pay as much tax, including GST, and the business benefits because FBT (up to 47% of the vehicle use that isn't strictly business) is not payable on an EV, the maintenance costs are far lower, and no petrol will be needed. A similar option is an EV subscription, which is similar to the novated lease, but employees can try different kinds of EV without having to commit to a long period like a lease.

Both options involve the employer, the employee and a specialist lease provider. The payment for the car comes out of the employee's pay, and the employer remits it to the lease provider. The provider may require a credit check, and perhaps a deposit.

A self-employed person with an ABN (Australian Business Number) may also be able to lease a car for themselves as an employee of their business. Ask an accountant about what might work for your situation.

It's sensible to look through the contract carefully and be sure that you understand what will happen if you leave your employment for any reason, and what your choices will be at the end of the lease period. Always seek your own independent legal and financial advice.

To be eligible, the EV must be:

- **held and used for the first time on or after July 1, 2022**
- **used by a current employee or their associates, such as family members**
- **not the subject of luxury car tax**

Julian Wood, Head of Channel Sales with leasing specialist Novated Lease Australia says "We've found the FBT exemption has increased tax savings for our customers significantly," he says. "We've worked out that buying a \$64,000 Tesla Model 3 has the same weekly net cost as a \$35,000 Toyota Corolla when doing both through a novated lease, due to these tax benefits."

EVs eligible for the FBT exemption

Here are some examples of electric models currently eligible for the government's Fringe Benefits Tax exemption, based on the current luxury car tax threshold. Please note that eligibility may vary depending on specification grade and on-road costs.

- **BMW iX1**
- **BYD Atto 3**
- **BYD Dolphin**
- **BYD Seal**
- **Cupra Born**
- **Fiat 500e**
- **Hyundai Kona Electric**
- **Hyundai Ioniq 5**
- **Hyundai Ioniq 6**
- **Kia Niro Electric**
- **Kia EV6**
- **MG 4**
- **MG ZS EV**
- **Mini Electric**
- **Nissan Leaf**
- **Polestar 2**
- **Renault Megane E-Tech**
- **Tesla Model 3**
- **Tesla Model Y**
- **Volvo C40 Recharge**
- **Volvo XC40 Recharge**

Some Good News for Apartment Living - Government Rooftop Solar funding

\$25 million rooftop solar boost

The Australian and New South Wales Governments have launched a new \$25 million program to boost rooftop solar energy adoption in apartment buildings, aiming to make clean energy more accessible for residents.

The program, the Solar for Apartment Residents incentive, will provide co-funding for owners' corporations and strata managers to install shared rooftop solar systems, potentially saving residents up to \$600 per year on energy bills.

Currently, apartments make up one in five homes in NSW, yet only around 3.5 per cent of them have access to solar.

The initiative seeks to address this gap by covering up to 50 per cent of installation costs, with a cap of \$150,000 per project.

The funding is part of the Federal Government's Solar Banks Scheme, a program designed to make renewable energy more accessible to households across Australia.

NSW Government will oversee the program, assess applications and distribute funds to successful applicants.

Eligible properties include apartment buildings with three to 55 units that have not installed a solar PV system in the past 10 years.

Applications are open until 1 December 2025, or until funds are fully allocated.

NSW Minister for Climate Change and Energy Penny Sharpe said the initiative would remove key barriers for apartment residents looking to access renewable energy.

"Solar should be available to everyone. This program removes the barriers to renewable energy for units and apartments, making it easier and more affordable to adopt solar," she said.

For more renewable and solar news, subscribe to [ecogeneration](#).

Tilba Halls project progress

Good afternoon all

The construction work is now well underway. The extensions at the rear of the big hall see the concrete slab laid, with blockwork and framing around the amenities and lift on the lower ground floor. The floor for the ground floor level is completed enabling the framing for the kitchen and store room to start this week.

Meanwhile in the little hall progress has been slowed due to the necessity for considerable remedial work. Deteriorating foundations particularly at the front led to subsidence of the walls and a consequent leaning to one side. The builder, Steph and our structural engineer are all working together on solutions to ensure the halls are good for another 100 years. It's all quite a balancing act with the addition of steelwork whilst trying to maintain the originality and heritage values.

All but one of the subcontracts are now in place and we're now on track to complete by the end of this year.

See the link below for some recent pics

Regards

Tony

Putting communities at the centre of the renewable energy shift

What might a Local Energy Hub mean for the Eurobodalla and Far South Coast?

SHASA's related organisations in the Hunter region think it might help them to get more renewables projects underway.

https://www.localenergyhubs.org.au/hunter_needs_local_energy_hub

"Hunter Jobs Alliance Coordinator Justin Page says a [Local Energy Hub](#) could bridge the gap between governments, industry and the communities being asked to host renewable energy infrastructure like wind and solar farms, batteries and new transmission lines.

Mr Page said Ausgrid's consultation process in the Hunter Central Coast region is a good example of why the Hunter needs a Hub.

"The Ausgrid upgrades are key to getting access to cheap renewable energy, creating local jobs and local economic benefits, but the conversation about why it is needed, where it will go and how it will be rolled out is still not happening adequately," he said.

RE-Alliance, alongside partners Community Power Agency and Yes2Renewables, has been calling on the Federal Government to address the information gap on Australia's shift to renewables with [Local Energy Hubs](#) in renewable energy regions.

"These hubs would be physical centres with a strong outreach program in renewable energy regions, staffed by independent local experts to help build trust and provide accurate information about what's happening," Mr Bray said.

The Federal Member for Hunter Dan Repacholi MP and Federal Member for Newcastle Sharon Claydon MP have both [publicly backed](#) the need for a Local Energy Hub in the Hunter.

Hunter Jobs Alliance Coordinator Justin Page added: "Hubs are a no-brainer for the Hunter, the question we've got for the Federal Government is why don't we have one yet?"

More information on the Local Energy Hubs model can be found at: [localenergyhubs.org.au/home](https://www.localenergyhubs.org.au/home).

Electric Vehicles to the rescue in Queensland:

'Electric cars saved the day for drivers affected by Cyclone Alfred blackouts on the weekend.

An increasing number of electric and plug-in hybrid cars have a "vehicle to load" function that allows you to send power from the car's main battery to external appliances. It means EV owners can keep their fridge cold during power outages, or use their car to top up smartphones and other devices.

The tech is in several models including the MG4, Hyundai Ioniq 5, Kia EV6, Mitsubishi Outlander PHEV and BYD Shark – but not Tesla electric cars. Facebook groups for BYD and MG owners had several stories of owners who used cars to power home appliances.

One BYD owner said they "used our Atto to power our fridge, lights and home office for three days after storms took out power". Another said "I have a power cable running to my neighbours – it's powering their fridge as well as our two fridges! Love my BYD even more right now".

An MG owner said "we relied on our MG4 51 Excite for power over the last 36 hours. We ran a beast of a fridge, devices, kettle, and my coffee machine (vital). With our consumption we lost about 10 per cent a day, and probably could have lasted a full week. Really thankful for this technology, so much better than a generator".'

<https://www.adelaidenow.com.au/.../fca48ee1c790ffd094fed8...>

Source: [1,000% Renewables for South Australia](#)

More:

The Chargers to use EVs to provide power in blackouts

A clever campaign could soon see electric car owners saving the very people who have spent years hating on them.



[David McCowen](#) [@davemccowen](#) 2 min read November 12, 2024 - 7:31AM Motoring



The Chargers are EV volunteers who donate power following a disaster. Picture: Supplied
News.com also covered the story

Electric car owners can volunteer to help their neighbours during a blackout by serving as mobile power stations this summer.

Many EVs can offload power from their main battery to household appliances such as mobile phones, power banks, fridges, kettles or microwaves.

Owners of cars with the so-called “vehicle to load” capacity can volunteer to drive to areas affected by power outages following a natural disaster and donate power to help people without access to electricity.



The Chargers are EV volunteers who donate power following a disaster. Picture: Supplied
Known as The Chargers, the program has been established by Mycar Tyre and Auto, a servicing network formerly known as Kmart Tyre and Auto.

Owners of EVs including BYD's Atto 3, Dolphin or Seal, the Genesis GV60, GV70 and GV80, Hyundai Ioniq 5 and 6, Kia EV6, EV9 and Niro, MG4 and MG ZS EV can register to become a charger.

Tesla's EVs are not eligible for the program.

Those who participate will be notified of a natural disaster by SMS, then asked to prepare and confirm their availability by email.



2023 Hyundai Ioniq 6.

Volunteers then drive to established meeting point and complete charging assignments, helping the affected community.

They then check out, leave the area and let their charging team know when they've safely arrived home.

The service will be trialled initially in QLD, NSW, ACT and Victoria.

A Lead Charger employed by Mycar will work with authorities such as the SES to determine where volunteers can safely help, then co-ordinate their response.

Mycar chief customer officer Adele Coswello said "everyone knows you can charge an EV, but the fact many can also be a source of power is still quite new information".

"At Mycar, we wanted to raise awareness of the benefits of discharging an EV, especially as our research shows Aussie drivers would provide power from their EV if they knew they could help the community in times of need," she said.

"We know that many drivers purchase EVs with the intent to reduce emissions and have a greener footprint.



2024 BYD Shark 6. Picture: Supplied

“That’s why we’re encouraging EV drivers to roll up their sleeves and take part in the trial to help support those while they’re getting back on their feet.”

Jaimie Bloch, a clinical psychologist and behavioural expert, said people experience a lot of uncertainty and trauma during and after natural disasters.

“Often, these disasters result in a loss of access to power, putting more strain on families, and placing additional stress and anxiety on an already overwhelming situation,” she said.

“Without access to power, Aussies feel a disconnection to the community and access to everyday resources that are vital to bringing back a sense of normalcy after natural disasters.”

More info: [Mycar.com.au](https://mycar.com.au)

SHASA in new exhibition: Regrowth - Healing Land and Community

Batemans Bay Heritage Museum,
16th March to 16th June
Opening Sunday 16th March at 1:30pm

The 2019-2020 bushfire season was one of the most intense and destructive bushfire seasons in recorded Australian history, and has become known as the Black Summer. In the years since, the Eurobodalla community has risen to meet these challenges, and worked hard to make sure we are in a better place now than we were five years ago. This exhibition documents some of the work that the community has done to heal and empower its members for future extreme events. Featuring artefacts, artworks and stories of regeneration, recovery and readiness, this exhibition highlights and celebrates the many ways our community has come together to address the challenges faced during the Black Summer bushfires, while providing a space to reflect on the areas where we still have work to do.

SHASA's work is highlighted in the exhibition through its network of heatwave and bushfire smoke havens and its hosting of the Nestwell platform, which was borne from the need to take the pressure off evacuation centres during the Black Summer bushfires by providing alternative places to shelter. This is done by encouraging the community to identify any unused or under-utilised resource that can be used for accommodation or shelter during a disaster, anything from garages to empty shops to sheds to caravans to community halls to land. Nestwell allows people to list any accommodation they can offer, control its availability and offer it to who they feel it is most suited to (such as families with children, vulnerable community members with pets, or people with disability without family support etc). And then Nestwell allows this accommodation to be found by those who need it, when they need it most.

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The heat havens are listed on the Nestwell platform, so that people can at least find community facilities where they can shelter from heatwaves and bushfires, as well as any private property that community members may offer in response to a disaster.

Check out Nestwell as part of this exhibition. Find your nearest heat haven. What accommodation or shelter could you offer in the event of a disaster?

Andrew Everard to read cov



**Four reasons why
renewable energy
like wind and solar
has never been
stronger.**



1.

**Renewables hit
a record 46%
of Australia's
electricity in
late 2024—set
to grow to 82%
in the next
five years!**



2.



**4 million Aussie
homes now have
rooftop solar—that's
37% of all households
soaking up the sun.**



3.

**Renewables
are officially
Australia's
cheapest
source of
new energy.**



4.



**Rooftop solar and
renewables backed
with big batteries are
making Australia's
energy more reliable.**



**Solar is good for
people, good for
the planet—and
ready to go now!**

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